

Superstition

Eb Dorian · ~100 BPM · 4 Weeks

Daily Practice Plan + Workbook — Guitar & Piano

S1
PLOGGER
10
min

S2
INTEGRATED
18
min

S3
SONG WORK
14
min

S4
JAMMING
10
min

S5
SYNTHESIZER
8
min



ANCHOR SONG — SPRINT 4

Superstition — Stevie Wonder

Eb Dorian (Eb–F–Gb–Ab–Bb–C–Db) · ~100 BPM · Modal vamp on Eb7 · Strong offbeat / clav-driven groove

PRIMARY — HARMONY CHAMBER

Progressions #1–#4 consolidated: I-IV-V-I, I-V-vi-IV, 12-Bar Blues, ii-V-I. All four internalized across sprints 2–4. ii-V-I = drill vehicle only.

SECONDARY — MELODY CHAMBER

Duration Amplifies Zone — how note length shapes tension. Zone 3 (4) introduced in Dorian context. Hear before you play.

VOICINGS CHAMBER

Triad shapes by stringset (guitar) — all inversions on all 4 string sets. Beato pp. 93–100. Piano: triad arpeggios + shell voicings in 5 keys.

RHYTHM CHAMBER

Son Clave 2-3 added to 3-2. Groove development 4-step: boring → anticipations → stops → clave sync. Superstition clav pattern as primary groove.

NON-NEG.

1. Sing before you play — every exercise, every day.

2. Anchor song appears in every section.

3. Slow is fast — never outpace your ears.

PLOGGER FOUNDATION — SPRINT 4

Ch.7: Interval Spelling at Keyboard — Pythagorean method, no formulas

Ch.8: Interval Spelling on Staff — all 8 clefs (treble, bass, S, MS, A, T, Bar, Perc)

Ch.9: Di-Chord Numbers intro — [1]–[7] named, associated with traditional interval names

Read this before you practice — Week 1 conceptual anchors

These are the ideas your hands will be enacting. Read, hum, tap, then open your instrument.

PLOGGER CH.7 — INTERVAL SPELLING AT KEYBOARD

The Pythagorean method: F–C–G–D–A–E–B is the natural ordering of the seven white notes by fifths. To name any interval, find both notes in this chain and count the steps between them. A "2nd" skips one letter; a "5th" skips four. **No formulas. No memorisation of half-steps.** You navigate the chain.

Superstition context: Eb–Bb is a 5th. Eb–Ab is a 4th. Every note in the Eb7 chord is a di-chord relationship you will spell this week.

PLOGGER CH.8 — ALL 8 CLEFS

The 8 clefs are: Treble (G-clef, 2nd line), Bass (F-clef, 4th line), Soprano (C-clef, 1st line), Mezzo-Soprano (C-clef, 2nd line), Alto (C-clef, 3rd line), Tenor (C-clef, 4th line), Baritone (C-clef, 5th line / F-clef, 3rd line), Percussion (neutral).

The C-clef family all share one anchor: middle C sits on the clef's pointer line. From there, everything else counts up or down. **One rule, 5 clefs.**

MELODY — DURATION AMPLIFIES ZONE

A half-note on Zone 2 creates more tension than a quarter-note on Zone 2. Duration doesn't change the zone — it amplifies it. The longer you hold a tense note, the more the ear wants it to move.

Zone 3 in Dorian: the 4̣ (Ab over Eb7) is mildly dissonant — the Dorian characteristic note is actually the natural 6̣ (C), which is Zone 2. Ab sits as a strong passing colour. **Hear before you play.**

HARMONY — 4 PROGRESSIONS CONSOLIDATED

This sprint locks in all four progressions you've been building since Sprint 2. The ii-V-I (Progression #4) is a *drill vehicle* — it tests your ear on root movement by 5th/4th and voice-leading smoothness. It is not the spine of music. Superstition is built on a modal vamp — Eb7 as home — which uses *none* of these progressions in the traditional sense.

Your job: know all four cold, then hear that Superstition lives outside them.

VOICINGS — TRIAD SHAPES BY STRINGSET

A triad has 3 notes and 3 inversions. On guitar, those 3 notes can live on any 3 adjacent strings (strings 1-2-3, 2-3-4, 3-4-5, or 4-5-6). Each stringset produces different physical shapes but the same harmonic content. **Learn the shapes physically before connecting them theoretically.**

On piano: triad arpeggios (root → 3rd → 5th → 8va, then back down) build the same finger-memory for inversion shapes.

RHYTHM — SON CLAVE + SUPERSTITION GROOVE

3-2 clave (from Sprint 3): 3 strokes in bar 1, 2 strokes in bar 2.
2-3 clave (Sprint 4 new): Same pattern, bars flipped — 2 strokes lead, 3 follow. Both are equally valid orientations.

The Superstition clav riff lives in a 2-3 feel: the anticipation before beat 1 is bar 2's energy pulling forward. **Groove development 4-step:** start boring (on the beat) → add anticipations → add stops → sync with clave. Never skip step 1.

PLOGGER CH.9 INTRO — DI-CHORD NUMBERS [1]–[7]			
NUMBER	TRADITIONAL NAME	QUALITY NOTE	EXAMPLE (FROM EB)
[1]	Unison / Octave	Most stable — same pitch	Eb–Eb
[2]	Major 2nd	Active, wants to move	Eb–F
[3]	Minor 3rd	Non-harmonic, closed	Eb–Gb
[4]	Major 3rd	Harmonic, open	Eb–G (not in Dorian)
[5]	Perfect 4th	Stable but directional	Eb–Ab
[6]	Tritone	Maximum tension	Eb–A
[7]	Perfect 5th	Most stable open interval	Eb–Bb



1 SECTION 1 Plogger Foundation — Ch.7 Interval Spelling + Ch.8 All Clefs + Ch.9 Di-Chord Intro 10 min

CH.7 — KEYBOARD PYTHAGOREAN WALK S1 3 min

Lay your fretting hand on your leg, palm down (Lap Map position). Name: Eb, Bb, F, C, G in the F–C–G–D–A–E–B chain. Count aloud: "Eb is 3 flats left of F. Bb is 2 flats left of F." Confirm each interval in the chain by counting letter-steps. No keyboard needed — your lap IS the keyboard. **Hear before you play.**

Then: call out 5 random intervals from Eb (Eb → Ab, Eb → Bb, Eb → F, Eb → Gb, Eb → C). Spell each using only the chain. Say the di-chord number aloud.

CH.8 — CLEF FLASH (TREBLE + BASS THIS WEEK) S1 4 min

On a blank staff (or paper grid): draw a treble clef. Place Eb4, F4, Gb4, Ab4, Bb4, C5, Db5 — the Superstition Eb Dorian scale. Name each note aloud. Then redraw the same 7 notes in bass clef. Every note of Superstition is now visible in two clefs.

Mnemonic check: Treble lines = E-G-B-D-F ("Every Good Boy"). Bass lines = G-B-D-F-A. Both start one ledger below: middle C (C4) is one ledger below treble staff, one ledger above bass staff.

CH.9 — DI-CHORD NUMBER NAMING (EB CONTEXT) S1 3 min

Play two notes on guitar. Identify the di-chord number using the Pythagorean chain. Start with Eb–Bb (answer: [7] P5). Then Eb–Ab ([5] P4), Eb–Gb ([3] m3), Eb–F ([2] M2). **Sing both notes before naming.** The interval lives in your ear, not on the fretboard.

2 SECTION 2 Integrated Work — Voicings + Harmony + Melody + Rhythm 18 min

VOICINGS: TRIAD ROOT POSITION — STRINGS 1-2-3 (EB MAJOR) S1 5 min

Eb major triad root position on strings 1-2-3: Bb (string 1, fret 6), G (string 2, fret 8), Eb (string 3, fret 6). *This is actually a 2nd inversion — the root Eb is on the bottom, but let's confirm: root = Eb (string 3), 3rd = G (string 2), 5th = Bb (string 1). Root position confirmed.*

Hear before you play: sing Eb–G–Bb before placing fingers. Play slowly. Listen for the major quality. Then play 1st inversion (G–Bb–Eb, bottom to top) on same string set. Shift each note up: G (s3, fret 5), Bb (s2, fret 3), Eb (s1, fret 11 or low fret with bar). Compare the sound — same notes, different colour. **Sing before you play each shape.**

HARMONY: ALL 4 PROGRESSIONS — QUICK RECALL IN EB S2 5 min

Play all four progressions in Eb, open chord/barre shapes. One strum per chord, focus on hearing root movement:

- **I-IV-V-I:** Eb – Ab – Bb – Eb. Root movement: up 4th, up 2nd, down 5th. Feel: strong cadence.
- **I-V-vi-IV:** Eb – Bb – Cm – Ab. Root movement: down 4th, down 3rd, down 3rd. Feel: pop/rock resolution.
- **12-Bar Blues (Eb):** Eb7–Eb7–Eb7–Eb7 / Ab7–Ab7–Eb7–Eb7 / Bb7–Ab7–Eb7–Eb7. Sing the root of each chord before you play it.
- **ii-V-I (drill vehicle):** Fm7–Bb7–Eb (in Eb). This is a jazz exercise. It is not Superstition. Note: Superstition uses Eb7 as a modal home — not a dominant chord resolving somewhere. Keep these separate in your ear.

MELODY: DURATION AMPLIFIES ZONE — SINGLE-STRING DEMO S2 4 min

Over a sustained Eb7 drone (open low Eb + ring-out or backing track): play Ab (Zone 3, the 4) as a quarter note. Then hold it as a whole note. Notice: the tension feels heavier, more expectant. The zone doesn't change — duration amplifies it. **Sing before you play.**

Now play Bb (Zone 1, the 5 — stable) as a quarter, then a whole note. The stability also amplifies. Duration is a volume knob on tension — not a zone-changer.

RHYTHM: SON CLAVE 2-3 INTRODUCTION S1 4 min

Clap 3-2 clave first (review): Beat 1, beat 2-and, beat 3 (bar 1) | Beat 1-and, beat 3 (bar 2).

Now 2-3: Beat 1-and, beat 3 (bar 1) | Beat 1, beat 2-and, beat 3 (bar 2). The 2-bar phrase just flipped which bar leads. Tap foot on 1 and 3 while clapping clave. Say Longy syllables: "ta-te / ta / ta-te / ta / ta" across the 2 bars. The Superstition clav feel has this 2-3 orientation.



3 SECTION 3 Song Learning — Superstition (Eb Dorian)

14 min

GROOVE STEP 1: BORING — ON THE BEAT S1 4 min

Before anything, **listen to Superstition** once through. Notice: the clav enters on the "and" of beat 4 of the intro. It never plays on the downbeat of beat 1. This is the groove.

Now, deliberately ignore that. Play Eb7 (x6878x or your preferred barre) on beats 1-2-3-4, quarter notes, tempo ~80 BPM. Boring is the foundation. Foot taps on every beat. Say "one–two–three–four" aloud. This is Step 1 of groove development: establish the pulse before you syncopate it.

GROOVE STEP 2: ADD ANTICIPATIONS S2 5 min

Keep the foot tap. Now play Eb7 on beat 1, then anticipate beat 3 — strum on the "and" of 2 instead. Pattern: strum (1) — rest — strum (and-2) — strum (3) — rest — strum (and-4). **Sing before you play each strum** — "ta... ta-te ta... ta-te." This is Longy for the pattern.

Notice: the song now has forward momentum. The ear expects beat 3 to arrive but it came early — that's anticipation. Superstition's clav riff is built on this energy.

EB DORIAN SOUND — MODAL FEEL CHECK S2 5 min

Play the Eb Dorian scale ascending: Eb–F–Gb–Ab–Bb–C–Db–Eb. Use one string (low Eb string: frets 0-2-3-5-7-9-10-12, or equivalent position). **Sing each note as you play.** The characteristic Dorian sound: minor 3rd (Gb) but natural 6th (C). That C is what makes Dorian sound brighter than Aeolian (natural minor).

Now play just: Eb–Gb–C–Eb. Hear the Dorian "flavour" — the minor chord with the bright 6th. This is Superstition's harmonic home.

4 SECTION 4 Free Play / Jamming

10 min

EB DORIAN IMPROV — ZONES ONLY S2 10 min

Set a loop or have someone hold Eb7. Improvise using only the Eb Dorian scale. Your only rule: before each note, decide its zone in your head (or say it aloud). Zone 1 = stable (Eb, Bb). Zone 2 = colour (F, Gb, C, Db). Zone 3 = tension (Ab = 4 in Dorian context). **Sing before you play — always.**

Play long notes (whole, half). Notice how holding a Zone 2 note longer creates more tension than a quick passing tone. This is duration amplifying zone. No speed, no licks — just intention.

5 SECTION 5 The Synthesizer — Connect Everything

8 min

WEEK 1 SYNTHESIS CIRCUIT S2 8 min

Play this circuit once through at ~80 BPM. Each step = 30 seconds:

1. **Spell:** Say aloud: "Eb to Bb is a [7] — Perfect Fifth. Eb to Ab is a [5] — Perfect Fourth." Then play both intervals on guitar and sing them.
2. **Groove:** Play Eb7 vamp with Step 2 anticipations (and-2, and-4). Foot on 1-2-3-4. 30 seconds.
3. **Triad:** Play Eb major root position on strings 1-2-3. Sing the triad (Eb–G–Bb). Play 1st inversion. Sing again.
4. **Zone:** Over the vamp, play one long Ab (4 beats). Name it: "Zone 3 in Dorian. Duration amplifies tension."
5. **Anchor:** Hum the Superstition riff. Play it on guitar — just the rhythm, approximate pitches. Connect: this song = Eb Dorian = modal vamp = clav groove.
6. **Reflect (1 min):** Say one thing that clicked today. Write it in the workbook.



SESSION COMPLETE — GUITAR WEEK 1

60 minutes. Log today's session in the Workbook (Page 7). Rate your groove feel, interval-spelling confidence, and zone awareness on a 1–5 scale. Rest your fretting hand.



1 SECTION 1 Plogger Foundation — Ch.7 Interval Spelling + Ch.8 All Clefs + Ch.9 Di-Chord Intro 10 min

CH.7 — KEYBOARD PYTHAGOREAN: AT THE PIANO S1 3 min

Place your right hand on the keyboard, thumb on Eb4 (middle Eb). Say aloud: "F–C–G–D–A–E–B is my chain." Find Eb in this chain: between Ab and Bb, it is 3 steps left of F. Now identify these intervals from Eb4 by counting letter-steps: Eb → Bb (skip E–F–G–A = 4 steps = 5th = [7]), Eb → Ab (skip E–F–G = 3 steps = 4th = [5]), Eb → Gb (skip E–F = 2 steps = 3rd = [3]). **Play each interval and sing it before naming it.**

CH.8 — CLEF FLASH: TREBLE + BASS + ALTO S1 4 min

On paper or staff notebook: write the Eb Dorian scale (Eb–F–Gb–Ab–Bb–C–Db) in treble clef (right hand range), then in bass clef (left hand range, starting Eb2 or Eb3). This is your practical piano reading this week.

Then attempt Alto clef: the C-clef pointer sits on line 3 — that's middle C (C4). Count up: Eb is a minor 3rd above C, so it sits on the 4th space of alto clef. Write Eb there. **One rule (C-clef pointer = middle C) gets you into every C-clef variant.**

CH.9 — DI-CHORD NUMBERS: PLAY AND NAME S1 3 min

Play each di-chord from Eb4 with right hand. Sing both notes, then name the number: Eb+Bb = [7] stable open. Eb+Gb = [3] non-harmonic closed. Eb+Ab = [5] directional stable. Eb+F = [2] active. Eb+C = a 6th — count: E–F–G–A–B–C = 6 letter-steps. What di-chord number is a 6th? Beyond [7] means compound — note this as an extension. **Hear before you play. Always.**

2 SECTION 2 Integrated Work — Voicings + Harmony + Melody + Rhythm 18 min

VOICINGS: DORIAN HEPTACHORD + TRIAD ARPEGGIOS S1 6 min

Dorian heptachord (both hands, separately then together): RH: thumb on Eb4, play Eb–F–Gb–Ab–Bb–C–Db–Eb5. Fingering: 1-2-3-1-2-3-4-5. LH: pinky on Eb3, play same scale ascending. Fingering: 5-4-3-2-1-3-2-1. **Sing each note as you play.** Go slowly — 60 BPM one note per beat.

Triad arpeggio — Eb major, C minor: RH, root position. Eb major: Eb4–G4–Bb4–Eb5 (then back down). C minor: C4–Eb4–G4–C5. Play legato, listen for the quality difference. Sing: "do–mi–sol" for major, "do–me–sol" for minor (using solfège).

HARMONY: SHELL VOICINGS II-V-I IN C AND G S2 5 min

Shell voicings = root + 3rd + 7th (omit 5th). In C: ii = Dm7 (D–F–C), V = G7 (G–B–F), I = Cmaj7 (C–E–B) or C (C–E–G). In G: ii = Am7 (A–C–G), V = D7 (D–F#–C), I = Gmaj7 (G–B–F#). LH plays root, RH plays 3rd+7th (two-note voicing).

Voice-leading focus: in G7 → Cmaj7, the F (7th of G7) moves down a half-step to E (3rd of Cmaj7). The B (3rd of G7) holds as the 7th of Cmaj7. That smooth movement IS why ii-V-I sounds inevitable. Hear it. **Sing each voice as you move it.**

Reminder: ii-V-I is a drill vehicle. Superstition does not use this progression. Keep your ear calibrated.

MELODY: DURATION AMPLIFIES ZONE — PIANO DEMO S2 3 min

LH holds Eb7 (Eb–Bb–Db–G, shell or full). RH plays Ab4 (Zone 3, the 4): first as a quarter note, then hold for 4 beats using sustain pedal. Hear how duration deepens the tension. Then resolve to Bb (Zone 1) — immediate release. **Sing before you play every note.**

RHYTHM: SUPERSTITION LH GROOVE PATTERN S1 4 min

LH only, no RH. Play Eb3 on beat 1 (whole note feel, let ring). Then Eb3 on the "and" of 2. Then Bb2 on beat 4. Pattern: Eb (1) — Eb (and-2) — Bb (4). This is the broken-chord bass pattern underlying the Superstition feel. Say Longy: "ta... ta-te... ta." Repeat for 2 minutes at 80 BPM. Foot taps every beat.

Hear before you play: sing the pattern — "Eb... Eb... Bb" — before your hand moves.



3 SECTION 3 Song Learning — Superstition (Eb Dorian)

14 min

GROOVE STEP 1: BORING — LH ONLY, ON THE BEAT S1 4 min

Listen to Superstition. Then: LH plays Eb3 on every beat 1, 2, 3, 4. Whole pattern is quarter notes. Foot taps with LH. This is deliberately boring — that is the point. Establish pulse before syncopating. 80 BPM. **Sing "Eb–Eb–Eb–Eb" before your hand moves.**

GROOVE STEP 2: ADD OFFBEAT RH CHORD STABS S2 5 min

LH continues: Eb3 on beat 1, Eb3 on and-2, Bb2 on beat 4 (the groove from S2). Now add RH: play Eb7 chord stab (Gb4–Bb4–Db5) on the "and" of 2 and "and" of 4 — the offbeats. This is the keyboard-stab feel of Superstition.

Coordinate: LH Eb (beat 1) — LH Eb + RH stab (and-2) — LH Bb + RH stab (and-4). **Sing the RH chord stab rhythm before playing:** "rest-TA, rest-TA" (where TA = the stab on the and).

EB DORIAN SCALE — MODAL IDENTITY S2 5 min

Both hands together: play Eb Dorian scale (Eb–F–Gb–Ab–Bb–C–Db–Eb) in contrary motion — RH ascends while LH descends from Eb4. They mirror each other and land on Eb3 and Eb5 simultaneously. **Sing each note.**

Pause. Play just Eb + Gb + C (root, m3, M6 of Dorian). This three-note cluster defines the Dorian sound. Hear it. Name it: "Dorian means minor 3rd + natural 6th." Superstition = this sound.

4 SECTION 4 Free Play / Jamming

10 min

EB DORIAN IMPROV — LH VAMP + RH ZONES S2 10 min

LH: loop the Superstition groove pattern (Eb–Eb–Bb with offbeat feel). RH: improvise freely in Eb Dorian. Your only rule: name the zone of each note before you play it. Zone 1 (stable: Eb, Bb), Zone 2 (colour: F, Gb, C, Db), Zone 3 (tension: Ab). **Sing before you play. Always.**

Experiment: hold a Zone 2 note for a full bar. Hear the tension accumulate. Resolve to Zone 1. Notice the release. This is duration amplifying zone — in real time, in Superstition's musical world.

5 SECTION 5 The Synthesizer — Connect Everything

8 min

WEEK 1 SYNTHESIS CIRCUIT — PIANO S2 8 min

- Spell + Play:** Eb → Bb = [7], play it. Eb → Ab = [5], play it. Eb → Gb = [3], play it. Sing each before playing.
- Arpeggio:** Eb major triad arpeggio (Eb–G–Bb–Eb), root position, both hands separately. Then C minor (C–Eb–G–C).
- Shell Voicing:** Play ii–V–I in C (Dm7–G7–Cmaj7) with shell voicings. Sing the 3rd as it moves: F → B → E (Dm7 → G7 → Cmaj7). That half-step B → E movement IS the cadence.
- Groove:** Play Superstition groove (LH broken Eb7 + RH offbeat stabs) for 30 seconds at 85 BPM.
- Zone:** Over the groove, hold Ab (Zone 3) for 4 beats. Name: "4 in Dorian, duration amplifies tension." Resolve to Bb (Zone 1).
- Reflect (1 min):** What connected for you today? Say it aloud, then write it in the workbook.



SESSION COMPLETE — PIANO WEEK 1

60 minutes. Log today's session in the Workbook (Page 7). Rate your heptachord fluency, shell voicing clarity, and groove coordination on a 1–5 scale. Stretch your wrists.

Week 1 Goals + Daily Practice Log

My Week 1 Goals (write in your own words)

What do you want to be able to do by the end of Week 1 that you cannot do now?

Daily Practice Log

DAY	DATE	INSTRUMENT	MINUTES	GROOVE FEEL (1-5)	INTERVAL RECALL (1-5)	ZONE AWARENESS (1-5)	NOTES / WIN
Day 1							
Day 2							
Day 3							
Day 4							
Day 5							
Day 6							
Day 7							

Rhythm Log — Son Clave Practice

Each day, check which clave orientation you practiced. Add a note on feel.

DAY	3-2 CLAVE	2-3 CLAVE	SUPERSTITION GROOVE STEPS	NOTES
Day 1	☐	☐	Step ____	
Day 2	☐	☐	Step ____	
Day 3	☐	☐	Step ____	
Day 4	☐	☐	Step ____	
Day 5	☐	☐	Step ____	
Day 6	☐	☐	Step ____	
Day 7	☐	☐	Step ____	

EB DORIAN QUICK REFERENCE — KEEP THIS VISIBLE

SCALE
Eb F Gb Ab Bb C Db

ZONES (Z1=STABLE)
Eb Bb / F Gb C Db / Ab

CHORDS IN SONG
Eb7 | Ab7 | Bb7

BPM TARGET
~100 BPM / start 80

Song Work Log + Weekly Reflection + Synthesizer Check

Superstition — Song Work Log

Track what you worked on each day. Check off when you can do it without stopping.

- ☐ **Listened to Superstition start-to-finish with full attention**
Note the clav entry point, the offbeat feel, the Eb7 modal vamp
- ☐ **Groove Step 1: Can play boring quarter-note Eb7 vamp at 80 BPM**
- ☐ **Groove Step 2: Can add anticipations (and-2, and-4) without losing foot tap**
- ☐ **Can sing Eb Dorian scale from memory (Eb–F–Gb–Ab–Bb–C–Db)**
- ☐ **Can identify the Dorian "colour" note: C (natural 6th, Eb Dorian)**
- ☐ **Can demonstrate Duration Amplifies Zone on instrument: Zone 3 held vs. quick**

Weekly Reflection (end of Week 1)

WHAT CLICKED THIS WEEK?

WHAT STILL FEELS MUDDY?

ONE MOMENT WHERE "HEAR BEFORE YOU PLAY" ACTUALLY CHANGED SOMETHING:

THE MOST SURPRISING THING ABOUT SUPERSTITION'S GROOVE:

END-OF-WEEK 1 SYNTHESIZER CHECK

Can you connect these dots without looking at notes?

- ☐ Eb → Bb = [7] Perfect Fifth. Eb → Ab = [5] Perfect Fourth. I can spell these using the F-C-G-D-A-E-B chain.
- ☐ Treble clef lines = E-G-B-D-F. Bass clef lines = G-B-D-F-A. Middle C = ledger line between both.
- ☐ Eb Dorian = minor 3rd (Gb) + natural 6th (C). That natural 6th is what makes Dorian "brighter" than natural minor.
- ☐ ii-V-I is a drill vehicle. Superstition uses a modal vamp — Eb7 as home, not as a dominant chord resolving somewhere.
- ☐ Duration amplifies zone: holding Zone 3 longer makes the tension heavier — the zone itself doesn't change.
- ☐ 3-2 clave: 3 strokes bar 1, 2 strokes bar 2. 2-3 clave: same pattern, bars flipped. Superstition leans 2-3.

Building on Week 1

WEEK 2 Deepen — Add complexity to established patterns

PLOGGER — CH.8 FULL: ALL 8 CLEFS

Add C-clef family: Soprano (C on line 1), Mezzo-Soprano (C on line 2), Alto (C on line 3), Tenor (C on line 4), Baritone (C on line 5). Anchor: the pointer line = middle C. Drill: write Eb in each of the 5 C-clefs. One rule, five positions.

Superstition anchor: Find Eb4 in each C-clef on staff paper. Say aloud which line/space it occupies in each.

HARMONY — 4 PROGRESSIONS IN 3 KEYS

Expand all four progressions beyond Eb: play in C (easy reference key) and G (sharp key). Each progression, each key, one pass. Goal: the progressions feel like shapes in your ear and hands — not formulas you compute.

ii-V-I drill: Fm7–Bb7–Eb (Eb), Dm7–G7–C (C), Am7–D7–G (G). Shell voicings only, piano. Barre chords, guitar. *Not the spine of music. Sing before you play.*

VOICINGS — ADD STRINGS 2-3-4 (GUITAR) / 1ST INVERSION ARPEGGIOS (PIANO)

Guitar: Move Eb major and C minor triads to strings 2-3-4. Root position, then 1st and 2nd inversions. Physical feel is different from strings 1-2-3 — notice how the shapes change. Same notes, different hand position.

Piano: Triad arpeggios in 1st inversion (3rd on bottom): C major 1st inv = E–G–C–E. All 4 keys (C, G, F, Bb). Sing before you play each arpeggio.

RHYTHM — GROOVE STEPS 3 & 4 + SUPERSTITION SECTION B

Step 3 — Stops: Add one beat of silence per bar. Silence IS rhythm. On guitar: mute Eb7 on beat 3. On piano: lift hands completely on beat 2. The groove continues in your body even when the instrument is quiet.

Step 4 — Clave sync: Play your groove while clapping clave simultaneously (or have a metronome pulse the clave pattern). Notice where your groove aligns with clave and where it doesn't. Superstition's clav is the clave. **Sing before you play.**

MELODY — TINY TENSION ARC IN EB DORIAN

Compose a 4-note melody over Eb7 using Zone logic: Z1 → Z2 → Z3 → Z1. Example: Eb (Z1) → Gb (Z2) → Ab (Z3) → Eb (Z1). **Sing it first.** Then play it. Change note durations: what happens when you make the Z3 (Ab) a half note instead of a quarter? Duration amplifies the tension arc.

Anchor: Find this arc somewhere in the Superstition melody. Can you hear Stevie Wonder use Z3 (Ab) as a tension point?

WEEK 2 SYNTHESIZER — ALL CHAMBERS CONNECTED

At session end: play all 4 progressions in Eb (30 sec each). Then play Superstition groove at 90 BPM. Then improvise a 4-bar melody over the vamp — use at least one Zone 3 note held for 2 beats. Finish: state aloud which clef you feel most confident in and which feels shakiest.

WEEK 3 Consolidate — Full tempo, all stringsets, ii-V-I in 5 keys

PLOGGER — CH.9 DI-CHORD NUMBERS FLUENCY

Call-and-response drill: partner (or self) plays two notes anywhere on keyboard. Identify di-chord number instantly — no counting. Target: [1] through [7] in under 2 seconds each. If slower, return to Pythagorean chain. Speed = familiarity, not memorisation. **Sing before you name.**

HARMONY — II-V-I IN 5 KEYS (PIANO) / CAGED + STRINGSET TRIADS (GUITAR)

Piano: Shell voicing ii-V-I in C, G, F, Bb, D. Each key: 2 passes, hands together, at 70 BPM. Voice-lead: 3rd of V7 becomes 7th of I. Sing the resolution each time.

Guitar: Play Eb chord in 3 CAGED positions. Then play Eb major triad shapes across all 4 string sets (1-2-3, 2-3-4, 3-4-5, 4-5-6). 80 BPM, one shape per bar. **Sing before each shape.**

RHYTHM — FULL GROOVE AT 95 BPM + CLAVE SYNC

All 4 groove steps running simultaneously: anticipations + stops + clave alignment. Both instruments at 95 BPM. Target: 2 minutes continuous without losing the clave feel. If you lose it — back to Step 1, boring, rebuild. Never force tempo. **Hear before you play.**

MELODY — 5 KEY NOTES ANALYSIS: SUPERSTITION

Identify 5 significant notes in the Superstition verse melody. For each: (1) scale degree name, (2) zone, (3) duration in the original. Map to AMF: is Stevie using Duration Amplifies Zone intentionally? Where are the tension peaks in the vocal? **Sing the melody before analyzing.**

Week 4: No New Concepts — Lock In What You Have

Week 4 is purely integration. Every session this week reinforces what you built in Weeks 1–3. If something feels solid — play it musically, not just correctly. If something feels shaky — slow it down and rebuild. **Hear before you play. Sing before you play. Always.**



Guitar — Week 4 Goals

- ☐ All 4 string-set triad shapes (Eb major) at 80 BPM — root, 1st, 2nd inversion on each. Smooth, no pauses between inversions.
- ☐ CAGED: play Eb chord in 3 positions and name the CAGED shape for each.
- ☐ All 4 progressions in Eb, one pass each, no stopping — I-IV-V-I, I-V-vi-IV, 12-Bar Blues, ii-V-I (drill vehicle).
- ☐ Superstition groove at 95+ BPM with groove Steps 1–4 all present.
- ☐ Improvise over Eb7 vamp for 2 minutes using zones intentionally. At least one held Zone 3 note per 8 bars.



Piano — Week 4 Goals

- ☐ Eb Dorian heptachord, hands together, 60 BPM. Clean legato, no pauses.
- ☐ Triad arpeggios (major + minor, all inversions) in C, G, F, Bb — both hands separately at 70 BPM.
- ☐ Shell voicing ii-V-I in 5 keys (C, G, F, Bb, D). Sing the resolving voice (3rd of V7 → 7th of I) each time.
- ☐ Superstition groove: LH broken Eb7 + RH offbeat stabs at 95 BPM. 2 minutes continuous.
- ☐ Improvise over LH vamp with RH in Eb Dorian, naming zones before each phrase.

WEEK 4 JAM PROMPT — SUPERSTITION INTEGRATION

Set up a ~95 BPM Eb7 loop (or play along with the recording). Aim for a 5-minute continuous session where you:

- 1. Establish the groove (boring) — 30 seconds
- 2. Add anticipations — stay for 60 seconds
- 3. Add melody over the top — use Eb Dorian zones
- 4. Play one ii-V-I lick (Fm7–Bb7–Eb) as a transition — hear how it sounds DIFFERENT from the modal vamp world
- 5. Return to the modal vamp and land on a long Zone 3 (Ab) — let it breathe, then resolve to Eb (Zone 1)

No stopping. No correcting. No judgment. Just the music.

WEEK 4 SYNTHESIZER FULL CIRCUIT — EVERY SESSION

PLOGGER CHECK (2 MIN)

Name 3 intervals from Eb using only the Pythagorean chain. Write Eb in treble, bass, and one C-clef. Name di-chord numbers [1]–[7] from flash card or partner.

HARMONY CHECK (2 MIN)

Play all 4 progressions in Eb. No stopping. Hear the emotional arc of each — not just the chord names.

SONG CHECK (2 MIN)

Play Superstition groove at 95 BPM for 90 seconds. Then improvise 30 seconds of melody over it. Anchor: this is Eb Dorian, modal vamp, not any of the 4 progressions.

REFLECTION (2 MIN)

State: What was your strongest moment this session? What still needs work? Write one sentence in the workbook. Keep it specific and honest.

SPRINT 5 PREVIEW — WHAT’S GOING ON (MARVIN GAYE, EB MAJOR)

Plogger:

Ch.9 complete + Ch.10–11: Di-Chord pulsation + harmonic

Harmony:

Progressions #5–#7 added. vi-IV-I-V (Prog #5) introduced.

Melody:

Zone Distribution Ratios by song section

Key shift: Eb Dorian → Eb Major. Same root, different mode. Your ear will feel the brightness difference immediately.

Sprint Exit Assessment — Can you do these things?

Complete at the end of Week 4. Mark each item honestly. These are the Sprint 4 exit targets. *Partial credit is real progress — note the specifics.*

PLOGGER — MUSICAL OS TARGETS

- ☐ **Interval Spelling (Ch.7):** Can identify any interval on keyboard using Pythagorean method only — no formula, no half-step counting. Time target: under 3 seconds per interval.
- ☐ **All 8 Clefs (Ch.8):** Can read notes in treble, bass, soprano, mezzo-soprano, alto, tenor, baritone, and percussion clefs. For C-clef variants: the pointer line = middle C — one rule applied confidently.
- ☐ **Di-Chord Numbers (Ch.9 intro):** Can name di-chord numbers [1] through [7] and associate each with its traditional interval name. Can hear [7] (P5) vs [3] (m3) vs [6] (tritone) as distinct sounds.

HARMONY CHAMBER — 4 PROGRESSIONS INTERNALIZED

- ☐ **I-IV-V-I (Prog #1):** Can play in at least 3 keys on both instruments. Can hear the "strong cadence" quality. Can hum the root movement.
- ☐ **I-V-vi-IV (Prog #2):** Can play in at least 3 keys. Can identify this as the "pop/rock" progression emotionally. Can find it in a song by ear.
- ☐ **12-Bar Blues (Prog #3):** Can play in Eb (the Superstition key) fluently. Can sing the root movement of all 12 bars. Knows the IV-bar and V-bar positions.
- ☐ **ii-V-I (Prog #4 — drill vehicle):** Can play shell voicings ii-V-I in at least 5 keys (piano) or barre chord shapes in 3 keys (guitar). Can sing the voice-leading resolution. Understands this is NOT the spine of music — it is a drill vehicle for hearing root movement and voice-leading.

VOICINGS CHAMBER

- ☐ **Guitar:** All inversions on strings 1-2-3 and 2-3-4 for Eb major and C minor triads at 80 BPM. Can name root/1st/2nd inversion while playing.
- ☐ **Guitar:** Eb major on all 4 string sets (bonus: C minor too). Shapes feel different; sound same.
- ☐ **Piano:** Triad arpeggios, all inversions, in C-G-F-Bb. Both hands separately at 70 BPM. Sings each arpeggio before playing.
- ☐ **Piano:** Shell voicings ii-V-I in 5 keys. Voice-lead the 3rd of V → 7th of I. Smooth, no gap.

RHYTHM CHAMBER

- ☐ **Son Clave 3-2:** Can clap confidently with foot on beat 1-3. Can speak Longy syllables while clapping.
- ☐ **Son Clave 2-3:** Can flip the pattern orientation. Understands which bar leads in 2-3 vs 3-2.
- ☐ **Superstition groove:** Verse groove on both instruments at 95 BPM. All 4 groove steps present. Eb7 modal Dorian feel established — not a static chord, a living groove.
- ☐ **Groove development:** Can demonstrate all 4 steps (boring → anticipations → stops → clave sync) as a teaching sequence.

MELODY CHAMBER

- ☐ **Duration Amplifies Zone:** Can demonstrate with instrument — hold a Zone 3 note for 4 beats vs. 1 beat, explain the difference in tension.
- ☐ **Zone 3 in Dorian context:** Can name the 4 (Ab in Eb Dorian) as Zone 3. Can place it in a musical phrase that resolves to Zone 1.
- ☐ **Tiny Tension Arc:** Can compose and play a Z1 → Z2 → Z3 → Z1 4-note melody in Eb Dorian. Sings before playing.

PERFORMANCE READY CHECK

- ☐ **Can play Superstition verse groove from memory** — no sheet music, just the feel and the key. 95 BPM or close.
- ☐ **Eb Dorian sounds like home:** when you play Eb7, it doesn't feel like it "needs to go somewhere" — it IS somewhere.
- ☐ **"Hear before you play" is a reflex** — you notice when you DON'T do it, and you stop to sing first.
- ☐ **ii-V-I sounds different** from the Superstition modal vamp in your ear. You can explain why.

Sprint 4 Final Reflection

WHAT DOES EB DORIAN SOUND LIKE NOW, COMPARED TO WEEK 1?

ONE THING YOU WILL CARRY INTO SPRINT 5 (WHAT'S GOING ON, EB MAJOR):

MOST IMPORTANT MUSICAL INSIGHT FROM SPRINT 4: